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Affiliations

2026–	Johns Hopkins University, School of Government & Policy (Washington, DC) ▸ <i>Full Professor with tenure, and founding faculty member</i> ▸ <i>Professor by courtesy in the Dept. of Economics</i>
2023–	Peterson Institute for International Economics (Washington, DC); <i>Non-Resident Senior Fellow</i>
2014–	IZA–Institute of Labor Economics (LISER, Luxembourg); <i>Research Fellow</i>
2025–	<i>Journal of Economic Perspectives</i> (American Economic Association); <i>Associate Editor</i>
2021–	Centre for Research & Analysis of Migration (CReAM), Rockwool Fdn. (Berlin); <i>Research Fellow</i>
2023–	Center for Global Development (Washington, DC); <i>Distinguished Non-Resident Fellow</i>
2025–	Center for Economic Policy Research (CEPR, UK); <i>Invited Member</i> , Research & Policy Network on the Political Economy of Migration
2026–	Fulcrum Project (UCSD and Dartmouth); <i>Mentor</i>
2023–2026	Dept. of Economics, George Mason University (Fairfax, VA); <i>Full Professor with tenure</i>
2021–2023	US Agency for International Development; <i>Expert Development Economist</i> ▸ <i>Office of the Administrator, TS security clearance</i>
2002–2023	Center for Global Development (Washington, DC) ▸ <i>Director for Migration, Displacement, & Humanitarian Policy, 2019–2023</i> ▸ <i>Co-Director for Migration, Displacement, & Humanitarian Policy, 2017–2019</i> ▸ <i>Research Fellow, 2002–2010; Senior Fellow, 2010–2023; Research Manager, 2011–2017</i>
2022	Georgetown University (SFS & McCourt School); <i>Adjunct Professor</i>
2016–2022	<i>Journal of Population Economics</i> (Springer); <i>Associate Editor</i>
2016–2020	<i>World Development</i> (Elsevier); <i>Associate Editor</i>
2011	Dept. of Economics & Wagner School, New York University; <i>Visiting Scholar</i>
2003–2010	McCourt School of Public Policy, Georgetown University; <i>Affiliated Associate Professor</i>
2000–2002	Center for International Development, Harvard University; <i>Research Fellow</i>
1998–2000	World Bank; <i>Consultant</i> , environmental economics
1999	Bain & Company (Istanbul, Turkey); <i>Associate Consultant</i>
1996 & 1997	World Bank; <i>Summer Assistant</i> , environmental economics
1994–1995	Thomas J. Watson Foundation; <i>Watson Fellow</i> in Bogotá, Colombia & Cuiabá, Brazil

Academic Journal Articles

2026	“The effect of low-skill immigration restrictions on US firms and workers: Evidence from a randomized lottery”, <i>American Economic Journal: Applied Economics</i>, 18 (3): 43–82 (with Ethan G. Lewis). ⟨Pre-pub. version at NBER, IZA, CReAM, CESifo, CGD, and PIIE⟩ ▸ Summary for VoxEU; Featured in the NBER Digest, December 2022; Referenced by White House Council of Economic Advisers in Economic Report of the President, March 2023
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Academic Journal Articles, *continued*

- Covered by [Wall Street Journal](#) [bis], [NPR](#), [NBC](#), [CNN](#), [The Atlantic](#), [Bloomberg Law](#) [bis], [Forbes](#), [IZA Newsroom](#) ([Auf Deutsch](#)), [Macro Roundup](#)
- 2026 “Migration or Stagnation: Aging and Economic Growth in the Republic of Korea Today, the World Tomorrow”, *Asian Development Review*, forthcoming. *⟨Preliminary, pre-pub. versions at [PIIE](#) and [CGD](#)⟩*

 - Covered by [The Economist](#), [Asia Business Daily](#)
 - Interactive: [Korea faces income losses within half a century without more labor migration](#)
- 2024 “Migration from Developing Countries: Selection, Income Elasticity, and Simpson’s Paradox”, *Journal of Development Economics*, 171 (October), 103359 (with Mariapia Mendola). *⟨Pre-pub. versions at [IZA](#), [CGD](#), and [Centro Studi Luca d’Agliano](#)⟩*

 - [Research Summary](#) for VoxDev at CEPR
 - Covered by [The Economist](#); [United Nations Dispatch](#); [Bistandsaktuell](#); [IZA Newsroom](#)
- 2023 “Human Capital Investment under Exit Options: Evidence from a Natural Quasi-Experiment”, *Journal of Development Economics*, 163: 103112 (with Satish Chand). *⟨Pre-pub. versions at [CGD](#) and [IZA](#)⟩*

 - Covered by [The Economist](#), [The Atlantic](#) (bis), [Guardian Nigeria](#)
- 2023 “Labour Mobility with Vocational Skill: Australian Demand and Pacific Supply”, *Australian Ec. Rev.* 56 (4): 462–486 (with Satish Chand). *⟨Pre-pub. versions at [IZA](#) and [CGD](#)⟩*
- 2022 “The economic and fiscal effects on the United States from reduced numbers of refugees and asylum seekers”, *Oxford Review of Economic Policy*, 38 (3): 449–486. *⟨Pre-pub. versions at [IZA](#) and [CGD](#)⟩*

 - Covered by [Boston Globe](#), [Marketwatch](#), [Forbes](#), [El País](#), [NewsNation](#), [Dziennik Gazeta](#)
- 2022 “Migration on the Rise, a Paradigm in Decline: The Last Half-Century of Global Mobility”, *AEA Papers & Proceedings*, 112: 257–261. *⟨Pre-pub. versions at [IZA](#), [CReAM](#), and [CGD](#)⟩*
- 2022 “The effect of seasonal work visas on native employment: Evidence from U.S. farm work in the Great Recession”, *Review of International Economics*, 30 (5): 1348–1374. *⟨Pre-pub. versions at [IZA](#) and [CGD](#)⟩*

 - Covered by the [Washington Post](#) (bis), [Fortune](#), [News & Observer](#)
 - Referenced in [U.S. Congress debate](#) (video)
- 2022 “A Pacific Skills Visa: Improving Opportunities for Skilled Migration Throughout the Pacific Region”, *Asia & the Pacific Policy Studies*, 9 (3): 430–446 (with Satish Chand and Helen Dempster). *⟨Pre-pub. version at [CGD](#) and [IZA](#)⟩*
- 2021 “Violence, development, and migration waves: Evidence from Central American child migrant apprehensions”, *Journal of Urban Economics*, 124 (July): 103355. *⟨Pre-pub. versions at [IZA](#) and [CGD](#)⟩*

 - Covered by [New Yorker](#); [Washington Post](#) (bis); [Wall Street Journal](#); [The Atlantic](#); [American Prospect](#); [Forbes](#); [PolitiFact](#)
- 2019 “The Place Premium: Bounding the Price Equivalent of Migration Barriers”, *Review of Economics and Statistics*, 101 (2): 201–213 (with Claudio Montenegro and Lant Pritchett). *⟨Pre-pub. versions at [CGD](#), [Harvard University](#)⟩*

 - Covered by the [New York Times](#); [The Economist](#) (bis); [The Atlantic](#); [Axios](#); [El País](#); [Quartz](#); [Vox](#)
 - Replication code at DOI:10.7910/DVN/DHZUOT
- 2019 “The New Economic Case for Migration Restrictions: An Assessment”, *Journal of Development Economics*, 138: 153–164 (with Lant Pritchett). *⟨Pre-pub. versions at [CGD](#), [IZA](#), and [Harvard University](#)⟩*

 - Covered by the [New York Times](#) and [The Economist](#)
 - Replication code and data at DOI:10.7910/DVN/HFTDQZ

Academic Journal Articles, *continued*

- 2019 “The Labor Market Effects of Refugee Waves: Reconciling Conflicting Results”, *ILR Review*, 72 (4): 818–857 (with Jennifer Hunt). [〈Pre-pub. version〉](#); Co-released with [CGD](#), [LSE](#), [IZA](#), and [CEPR](#)
- ▷ Summary for VoxEU
 - ▷ Covered by [The Atlantic](#), [NPR Planet Money](#); [New York Times](#); [Bloomberg](#); [Wall Street Journal](#); [The Economist](#) (bis); [Washington Post](#); [CNBC](#); [U.S. News](#); [Miami New Times](#); [Huffington Post](#); [Bloomberg Surveillance](#) (1:20:15)
- 2018 “Immigration Restrictions as Active Labor Market Policy: Evidence from the Mexican *Bracero* Exclusion”, *American Economic Review*, 108 (6): 1468–1487 (with Ethan G. Lewis and Hannah M. Postel). [〈Pre-pub. versions at NBER, CGD, and IZA〉](#)
- ▷ Summary for VoxEU
 - ▷ Covered by [New York Times](#) (bis); [The Economist](#) (bis, bis); [WSJ](#); [AP](#); [Frankfurter Allgemeine Zeitung](#); [Vox](#); [El Diario](#); [Newsweek](#); [NY Daily News](#); [Bloomberg](#); featured by [NBER Digest](#)
 - ▷ Replication code and data at <https://dataverse.harvard.edu/dataverse/bracero>
- 2018 “Why don’t remittances appear to affect growth?”, *Economic Journal*, 128 (612): F179–F209 (with David McKenzie). [〈Pre-pub. version〉](#); Co-released with [World Bank](#)
- ▷ Covered by [The Economist](#)
- 2018 “Deterring Emigration with Foreign Aid: An Overview of Evidence from Low-Income Countries”, *Population and Development Review*, 44 (4): 667–693 (with Hannah M. Postel). [〈Pre-pub. version〉](#); Co-released with [GLM-LIC](#) and [IZA](#)
- ▷ Covered by [Financial Times](#); [New York Times](#); [The Economist](#); [Washington Post](#); [The Guardian](#); [Mother Jones](#); [CS Monitor](#); [Die Welt](#); [El País](#); [De Standaard](#); [CQ Researcher](#); [Vox](#)
- 2018 “Testing for repugnance in economic transactions: Evidence from guest work in the Gulf”, *Journal of Legal Studies*, 47 (S1): S5–S44. [〈Pre-pub. version〉](#); Co-released with [IZA](#)
- ▷ Covered by the [Washington Post](#)
- 2017 “Split Decisions: Household Finance When a Policy Discontinuity Allocates Overseas Work”, *Review of Economics and Statistics*, 99 (3): 531–543 (with Erwin R. Tiongson). [〈Pre-pub. version〉](#)
- ▷ Replication code and data at DOI:10.7910/DVN/2DO8QP
- 2017 “The Meaning of Failed Replications: A Review and Proposal”, *Journal of Economic Surveys*, 31 (1): 326–342. [〈Pre-pub. version〉](#)
- 2017 “Temporary Work Visas as U.S.-Haiti Development Cooperation: A Preliminary Impact Evaluation”, *IZA Journal of Labor & Development*, 6: 4 (with Hannah Postel). [〈Pre-pub. version〉](#)
- ▷ Replication code and data at DOI:10.7910/DVN/J6P2KT
 - ▷ Covered by [The Economist](#) (bis, ter); [Washington Post](#); [Reuters](#); [NBC](#); [CNN](#); [UPI](#); [Miami Herald](#); [La Opinión](#)
- 2016 “The New Role for the World Bank”, *Journal of Economic Perspectives*, 30 (1): 53–76 (with Michael Kremer). [〈Pre-pub. version〉](#)
- ▷ Covered by [Vox](#)
- 2016 “Losing Our Minds? New research directions on skilled migration and development”, *International Journal of Manpower*, 37 (7): 1227–1248. [〈Pre-pub. version〉](#)
- ▷ Covered by the [Financial Times](#)
- 2015 “Global Skill Partnerships: A proposal for technical training in a mobile world”, *IZA Journal of Labor Policy*, 4:2. [〈Pre-pub. version〉](#)
- ▷ Proposal endorsed by the [UN Secretary General](#) and the [UN Marrakesh Compact for Migration](#), Objective 18. Covered by [Inter Press Service](#); [El País](#)

- 2015 “Skill Development and Regional Mobility: Lessons from the Australia-Pacific Technical College”, *Journal of Development Studies*, 51 (11): 1502–1517 (with Colum Graham and Stephen Howes). [〈Pre-pub. version〉](#)
 - 2014 “A case against taxes and quotas on skilled emigration”, *Journal of Globalization and Development*, 5 (1): 1–39. [〈Pre-pub. version〉](#)
 - 2014 “Migration and Development Research Is Moving Far Beyond Remittances”, *World Development*, 64: 121–124 (with Çağlar Özden and Hillel Rapoport). [〈Pre-pub. version〉](#)
 - 2013 “Why Do Programmers Earn More in Houston than Hyderabad? Evidence from Randomized Processing of U.S. Visas”, *American Economic Review, Papers & Proceedings*, 103 (3): 198–202. [〈Pre-pub. version〉](#)
 - Covered by [Bloomberg](#) and [Slate](#)
 - 2013 “Blunt Instruments: Avoiding Common Pitfalls in Identifying the Causes of Economic Growth”, *American Economic Journal: Macroeconomics*, 5 (2): 152–186 (with Sami Bazzi). [〈Pre-pub. version〉](#)
 - 2012 “Counting chickens when they hatch: Timing and the effects of aid on growth”, *Economic Journal*, 122 (561), 590–617 (with Steven Radelet, Rikhil Bhavnani, and Sami Bazzi). [〈Pre-pub. version〉](#)
 - Paper awarded the [Royal Economic Society Prize](#)
 - 2012 “Why were Latin America’s tariffs so much higher than Asia’s before 1950?”, *Journal of Iberian and Latin American Economic History*, 30 (1): 12–39 (with Jeffrey G. Williamson). [〈Pre-pub. version〉](#)
 - 2011 “Economics and Emigration: Trillion-Dollar Bills on the Sidewalk?”, *Journal of Economic Perspectives*, 25 (3): 83–106. [〈Pre-pub. version〉](#)
 - Covered by the [New Yorker](#); [New York Times](#); [The Economist](#) (bis, bis); [Fortune](#); [Forbes](#) (bis); [The Atlantic](#); [Salon](#); [NPR](#), [Deseret News](#)
 - Subject of the American Economic Association’s [inaugural Research Highlight 2015](#)
 - 2011 “When Does Rigorous Impact Evaluation Make a Difference? The Case of the Millennium Villages”, *Journal of Development Effectiveness*, 3 (3): 305–339 (with Gabriel Demombynes). [〈Pre-pub. version〉](#)
 - Replication code and data at DOI:[10.7910/DVN/28146](#)
 - Covered by the [Financial Times](#); [New York Times](#) (bis); [The Economist](#); [Nature](#) (bis); [Daily Mail](#)
 - 2008 “Income Per Natural: Measuring Development for People rather than Places”, *Population and Development Review*, 34 (3): 395–434 (with Lant Pritchett). [〈Pre-pub. version〉](#)
 - Covered by [The Economist](#) and [The Atlantic](#)
 - 2008 “New data on African health professionals abroad”, *Human Resources for Health*, 6:1 (with Gunilla Pettersson).
 - Replication code and data at DOI:[10.7910/DVN/28161](#)
 - 2007 “The trouble with the MDGs: Confronting expectations of aid and development success”, *World Development*, 35 (5): 735–751 (with Charles Kenny and Todd J. Moss). [〈Pre-pub. version〉](#)
 - 2007 “The ghost of 0.7%: Origins and relevance of the international aid target”, *International Journal of Development Issues*, 6 (1): 3–25 (with Todd J. Moss). [〈Pre-pub. version〉](#)
 - 2004 “Wealth Bias in the First Global Capital Market Boom, 1870-1913”, *Economic Journal*, 114 (495): 304–337 (with Jeffrey G. Williamson). [〈Pre-pub. version〉](#)
 - 2004 “Why Did the Tariff-Growth Correlation Change after 1950?”, *Journal of Economic Growth*, 9 (1): 5–46 (with Jeffrey G. Williamson). [〈Pre-pub. version〉](#)

Litigation Work, *continued*

- ▷ Covered by [CNN](#)
- 2025 Lead *Amicus* for ‘[Brief of Economists as Amici Curiae](#)’, in *Kristi Noem, Secretary of Homeland Security et al. vs. National TPS Alliance, et al.* (US Supreme Court, [Docket No. 25A326](#), [Case No. 25-5724](#))

▷ Also Lead *Amicus* in a [follow-up brief](#) for the US Court of Appeals, 9th Circuit ([25-5724](#), [Nov. 12, DktEntry: 43.1](#)), considering an expanded immigration population
- 2025 Signatory to ‘[Brief of Social Science Scholars as Amici Curiae](#)’, in *State of Washington et al. v. Donald J. Trump et al.* (US Court of Appeals for the Ninth Circuit, [2:25-cv-00127-JCC](#))
- 2023–2024 Expert witness on behalf of the defendant in *State of Arizona et al. v. Merrick Garland et al.* (US District Court, Western District of Louisiana, [6:22-cv-01130](#))

▷ Case against the defendant [dismissed](#)
- 2020 Declaration on behalf of the plaintiff in *Human Rights First v. Chad F. Wolf et al.* (US District Court DC, [1:20-cv-03764](#))

▷ Rule challenged by the plaintiff enjoined by *Pangea Legal Services v. DHS* ([3:20-cv-09253-JD](#))

Regulatory Comments

- 2026 “[Economic Effects of Employment Authorization Reform for Asylum Applicants](#)”, Comment on “Notice of Proposed Rulemaking: Employment Authorization Reform for Asylum Applicants” (91 *Fed. Reg.* 8616), US Citizenship & Immigration Services, Dept. of Homeland Security, Docket USCIS-2025-0370, RIN 1615-AC97 (with Amy Nice and Natalia Rigol).
- 2025 “[Comment challenging cost estimate provided by the Department of Homeland Security Request to Withdraw NPRM proposing a Wage Level Lottery for H-1B Selection](#)”, Comment on “Notice of Proposed Rule Making Establishing a Weighted Selection Process for Registrants and Petitioners Seeking to File Cap-Subject H-1B Petitions” (90 *Fed. Reg.* 45986), US Citizenship & Immigration Services, Dept. of Homeland Security, Docket USCIS-2025-0040, RIN 1615-AD01 (with Jeremy Neufeld and Amy Nice).
- 2025 “[Very high cost to the nation in deterring international STEM graduate students and postdocs if rule finalized as proposed](#)”, Comment on “Establishing a Fixed Time Period of Admission and an Extension of Stay Procedure for Nonimmigrant Academic Students, Exchange Visitors, and Representatives of Foreign Information Media” (90 *Fed. Reg.* p. 42070 to 42115) posted Aug 28, 2025 by Immigration and Customs Enforcement Bureau, Dept. of Homeland Security, Docket ICEB-2025-0001, RIN 1653-AA95 (with Jeremy Neufeld and Amy Nice).

Book Chapters

- 2015 “[Does Development Reduce Migration?](#)”, in Robert E. B. Lucas, ed., *International Handbook on Migration and Economic Development*, Northampton, Mass.: Edward Elgar Publishing, pp. 152–185. [〈Pre-pub. version〉](#)

▷ Covered by [The Economist](#); [New York Times](#); [Foreign Policy](#); [Der Spiegel](#); [Neue Zürcher Zeitung](#)
- 2013 “[Seize the Spotlight: A Case for GCC Engagement in Research on the Effects of Labor Migration](#)”. In *Labor Mobility: An Enabler for Sustainable Development*, Abu Dhabi: Emirates Center for Strategic Studies and Research, pp. 103–120. [〈Pre-pub. version〉](#)

Book Chapters, *continued*

- 2012 “The Collision of Development Goals and Impact Evaluation”, in Robert Peccoud, ed., *Evaluation and its Discontents: Do We Learn from Experience in Development?*, Proceedings of the 9th AFD-EUDN Conference, Paris: Agence Française de Développement, pp. 169–197.
- 2012 “Income per Natural: Measuring Development for People Rather Than Places”, in Oliver Bakewell, ed., *Migration and Development*, The International Library of Studies on Migration series, London: Edward Elgar Publishing, Ch. 34 (with Lant Pritchett).
- 2011 “The Labor Mobility Agenda for Development”, in Nancy Birdsall and Francis Fukuyama, eds. *New Ideas on Development after the Financial Crisis*, Baltimore: The Johns Hopkins University Press, pp. 260–287.
- 2011 “The Financial Consequences of High-Skill Emigration: Lessons from African Doctors Abroad”, in Sonia Plaza and Dilip Ratha, eds. *Diaspora for Development in Africa*, Washington, DC: World Bank, pp. 165–182.
- 2011 “Genuine Savings Rates in Developing Countries”, in Karl-Gustaf Löfgren and Chuan-Zhong Li, eds. *Green National Accounting And Sustainability*, Northampton, MA: Edward Elgar, pp. 653–676 (with Kirk Hamilton).
- 2010 “The Biggest Idea in Development That No One Really Tried”, in Emily Chamlee-Wright, ed., *The Annual Proceedings of the Wealth and Well-Being of Nations: 2009–2010, Volume II*, Beloit, WI: Beloit College Press, pp. 25–50.
- 2006 “Aid and Growth: The Current Debate and Some New Evidence”, in Peter Isard, Leslie Lipschitz, Alexandros Mourmouras, and Boriana Yontcheva, eds., *The Macroeconomic Management of Foreign Aid: Opportunities and Pitfalls*, Washington, DC: International Monetary Fund, pp 43–60 (with Steven Radelet and Rikhil Bhavnani).
- 2006 “A first look at the consequences of African health professional emigration”, in Treasury of Australia and Reserve Bank of Australia, *G-20 Workshop on Demographic Challenges and Migration: Sydney, 27-28 August 2005*, Canberra: Commonwealth of Australia, pp. 195–231.
- 2003 “Absorptive capacity: How much is too much?” and “Exit: How long should the MCA commitment last?”, in Steven Radelet, *Challenging Foreign Aid: A Policymaker’s Guide to the Millennium Challenge Account*, Washington, DC: Center for Global Development (with Steven Radelet).
- 2001 “Are we saving enough for the future?”, in Jonathan M. Harris, Timothy A. Wise, Kevin P. Gallagher, and Neva R. Goodwin, eds., *A Survey of Sustainable Development: Social and Economic Dimensions*, Washington, DC: Island Press, pp. 37–41 (with Kirk Hamilton).
- 1997 “Are we saving enough for the future?”, in World Bank, *Expanding the Measure of Wealth: Indicators of Environmentally Sustainable Development*, Environmentally Sustainable Development Studies and Monographs Series, No. 17, Washington, DC: World Bank (with Kirk Hamilton).
- 1997 “The Hidrovia Paraguay-Parana: A Review and Analysis of the Feasibility Studies and Environmental Assessment in the Context of Regional Development”, in Environmental Defense Fund, *The Hidrovia Paraguay-Parana Navigation Project: Report of an Independent Review*, Washington, DC: Environmental Defense Fund and Fundação Centro Brasileiro de Referência e Apoio Cultural/CEBRAC (with Thayer Scudder).

Policy Writings

- 2026 [“Firms allowed to hire immigrant manual laborers expand to hire more Americans”](#), *RealTime Economics*, Washington, DC: Peterson Institute for International Economics, July 2 (with Ethan G. Lewis).
- 2026 [“What does the new Duration of Status rule mean for international students and workers?”](#), *Brookings Commentary*, Washington, DC: Brookings Institution, July 17 (with Dan Berger, Stephen Yale-Loehr, Taylor Joseph, and Ezra Brown).
- 2026 [“Class dismissed: The effect of international student exclusion on the US STEM workforce and economic growth”](#), Policy Brief 26-10, Washington, DC: Peterson Institute for International Economics, June 23 (with Jeremy Neufeld and Amy M. Nice).
 ▶ Covered by [Fortune](#)
- 2026 [“The US is driving away international students at a long-term economic cost”](#), *RealTime Economics*, Washington, DC: Peterson Institute for International Economics, June 23.
- 2026 [“Leveraging AI to Expand Skilled Labour Mobility”](#), Washington, DC: Center for Global Development, May 11 (with Helen Dempster and Italian Labor Minister Marina Elvira Calderone).
- 2026 [“The economic case for a \\$100,000 tax on H-1B visas rests on several errors”](#), *Realtime Economics*. Washington, DC: Peterson Institute for International Economics, Mar. 16. *⟨Summarizing this research paper⟩*
- 2025 [“From Root Causes to Shared Gains: Migration Policy for Low-Income Countries in a Labor-Scarce World”](#), IZA Discussion Paper 18308. Commissioned by the International Monetary Fund. Bonn: IZA Institute of Labor Economics, Dec. 16. *⟨Co-released with RFBerlin⟩*
- 2025 [“Brain Freeze: How International Student Exclusion Will Shape the STEM Workforce and Economic Growth in the United States”](#), IZA Discussion Paper 18548, Commissioned by the National Academies of Sciences, Engineering, and Medicine for the [Reimagining STEMM Graduate Education and Postdoctoral Career Development Summit](#), Oct. 22 (with Jeremy Neufeld and Amy Nice).
⟨Co-released by NAS⟩
 ▶ Covered by [Forbes](#)
- 2025 [“New US curb on high-skill immigrant workers ignores evidence of its likely harms”](#). PIIE Realtime Economics, Washington, DC: Peterson Institute for International Economics, Sep. 22.
- 2025 [“Skilled immigration on the chopping block? Effects of eliminating ‘Optional Practical Training’ in the US”](#). PIIE Realtime Economics, Washington, DC: Peterson Institute for International Economics, Apr. 8.
- 2024 [“Modernizing the US Exchange Visitor Skills List”](#). PIIE Policy Brief, Washington, DC: Peterson Institute for International Economics, Sep. 5 (with William R. Kerr).
- 2024 [“Expelling Excellence: Exchange Visitor restrictions on high-skill migrants in the United States”](#), Washington, DC: Institute for Progress, Aug. 8 (with Jeremy Neufeld and Amy Nice). *⟨Jointly released by IZA⟩*
- 2024 [“Offering more lawful pathways for US border crossings reduces unlawful crossings”](#), Washington, DC: Peterson Institute for International Economics, Apr. 18.
 ▶ Covered by [Reason](#)
- 2024 [“Trump’s proposed mass deportations would backfire on US workers”](#), Washington, DC: Peterson Institute for International Economics, Mar. 6.
 ▶ Covered by [Financial Times](#), [The Economist](#), [US News & World Report](#) [bis], [Reason](#) [bis], [Telemundo](#), [Forbes](#) [bis, bis], [Washington Monthly](#), [Mother Jones](#), [Scripps News](#), [Frankfurter Allgemeine Zeitung](#), [FranceInfo](#)

Policy Writings, *continued*

- 2023 “[Why We Won’t Reach a ‘Climate Migrant’ Protection Category—And What We Can Do Instead](#)”, Washington, DC: Center for Global Development, Jun. 8 (with Sam Huckstep).
- 2023 “[Climate Change and Migration: An Omnibus Overview for Policymakers and Development Practitioners](#)”, CGD Policy Paper 292, Washington, DC: Center for Global Development, May 9 (with Sam Huckstep).
 ▶ Covered by [The Economist](#)
- 2022 “[Do Cash Transfers Deter Migration?](#)”, CGD Policy Paper 270, Washington, DC: Center for Global Development, Oct. 19. *⟨Co-released with IZA⟩*
- 2022 “[Doing Refugee Integration Better: Three Lessons from the Latest Research](#)”, Washington, DC: Center for Global Development, Oct. 19.
- 2022 “[Pathways for Labor Migration from Northern Central America: Five Difficult but Necessary Proposals](#)”, *North and Central American Task Force on Migration*, World Refugee and Migration Council, Jan. 13. *⟨Co-released with CGD and IZA⟩*
- 2021 “[Australia needs more Pacific mid-skill migration: Here’s how to facilitate it](#)”, *DevPolicy*, Oct. 15 (with Satish Chand and Helen Dempster).
- 2021 “[Expanding Legal Migration Pathways from Nigeria to Europe: From Brain Drain to Brain Gain](#)”, World Bank-CGD report, Jul. 19 (with Samik Adhikari, Helen Dempster, and Nkechi Linda Ekeator). *⟨Jointly released by World Bank⟩*
 ▶ Policy brief: “[Why Europe Should Build Legal Migration Pathways with Nigeria](#)”
 ▶ Covered by [Handelsblatt](#), [This Day](#)
- 2021 “[The Real Root Causes of America’s Border Crisis: And How Biden Can Address Them](#)”, *Foreign Affairs*, Jun. 7.
- 2021 “[Ethical Recruitment of Health Workers: Using Bilateral Cooperation to Fulfill the World Health Organization’s Global Code of Practice](#)”, CGD Policy Paper 212 (with Helen Dempster), May 27.
 ▶ Covered by [New York Times](#)
- 2021 “[The Missing Piece in Biden’s Plan for Central America: Bilateral Labor Agreements](#)”, CGD blog, Feb. 9.
- 2021 “[Should the Threat of Pandemics End the Age of Mobility?](#)”, *Think Global Health*, Jan. 28 (with Thomas Ginn).
- 2020 “[How economic development shapes migration: Facing the emigration life cycle](#)”, *Migration Policy Practice*, 10 (4): 31–34 (with Cassandra Zimmer).
- 2020 “[Restricting Mobility Will Not Stop the Next Pandemic](#)”, CGD Commentary and Analysis, Dec. 10 (with Thomas Ginn and Reva Resstack).
- 2020 “[Harnessing Northern Triangle Migration for Mutual Benefit](#)”, *White House and the World Policy Brief*, Dec. 3 (with Reva Resstack and Cassandra Zimmer).
- 2020 “[How economic development shapes emigration](#)”, *VoxDev* (commissioned), Sep. 21.
- 2020 “[Emigration Rises Along with Economic Development. Aid Agencies Should Face This, but Not Fear It](#)”, CGD blog, Aug. 18.
- 2020 “[The Future of Legal Migration: Labour Migration Pathways Between Europe and Africa](#)”, in Matteo Villa, ed., *The Future of Migration to Europe*, Milan: ISPI Istituto per gli Studi di Politica Internazionale (with Helen Dempster and Katelyn Gough).
- 2020 “[Migration and household finances: How a different framing can improve thinking about migration](#)”, *Development Policy Review*, 38 (1): 3–27 (with Timothy N. Ogden). *⟨Pre-pub. version at CGD⟩*
- 2020 “[Shared Border, Shared Future: A U.S.-Mexican Bilateral Worker Agreement](#)”, in Alex Nowrasteh and David J. Bier, eds., *12 New Immigration Ideas for the 21st Century*, Washington, DC: Cato Institute.

Policy Writings, *continued*

- 2019 [“Three Facts You Haven’t Heard Much About Are Keys to Better Policy Toward Central America”](#), CGD blog, Nov. 1 (with Jimmy Graham).
 ▸ Covered by *Mother Jones*
- 2019 [“Promoting New Kinds of Legal Labour Migration Pathways Between Europe and Africa”](#), CGD Policy Brief (with Helen Dempster and Katelyn Gough).
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Books

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- 1991 *Geometry for the Classroom*, New York: Springer-Verlag (with C. Herbert Clemens).

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- 1998 “[Estimating National Wealth: Methodology and Results](#)”, Environmental Economics Series, Paper Number 57, Washington, DC: World Bank (with Arundhati Kunte, Kirk Hamilton, and John Dixon).

Teaching

- 2026 **Short Course on the Economics of Immigration and Innovation** (PhD), Institute for Progress
- 2023–2026 **Economic Problems and Public Policies** (Undergrad.), George Mason University
- 2022 **How Migration Policy Shapes Economies, Local and Global** (Master’s), Georgetown University McCourt School of Public Policy and Walsh School of Foreign Service
- 2003–2010 **Macroeconomics and Thesis Advising** (Master’s), Georgetown University McCourt School of Public Policy
- 2005 **Foreign Aid Effectiveness** (Ph.D.), University of Copenhagen
- 2002 Certificate of Distinction in Teaching, Derek Bok Center for Teaching & Learning, Harvard Univ.
- 2001–2002 **Economic Development in East Asia** (Undergrad.), Harvard Univ. Dept. of Economics

Teaching, *continued*

2001 | **Globalization and History** (Undergrad.), Harvard Univ. Dept. of Economics

Education

2002 | **Ph.D., economics**, Harvard University Dept. of Economics, Cambridge, MA
 ▶ *NSF Graduate Research Fellowship; Derek Bok certificate of distinction in teaching*
 ▶ *Fields: Economic history, development economics, public economics*

1997 | **M.S., econ. & environmental management**, Johns Hopkins University, Baltimore, MD
 ▶ *Abel Wolman Merit Scholarship*

1994 | **B.S., engineering and applied science**, California Institute of Technology, Pasadena, CA

Honors

2013 | [Royal Economic Society Prize](#) for best paper published in the [Economic Journal](#) in 2012 (with co-authors Steven Radelet, Rikhil Bhavnani, and Sami Bazzi).

2010 | Invited for 15th [Sir Arthur Lewis Memorial Lecture](#), Eastern Caribbean Central Bank.

2010 | Devex.com “[40 young leaders shaping the way international relief and development assistance are being delivered](#)”.

1996–2000 | National Science Foundation [Graduate Research Fellowship](#).

Peer Reviews

Referee reports for *American Economic Review*, *Quarterly Journal of Economics*, *Review of Economic Studies*, *Review of Economics and Statistics*, *Journal of the European Economic Association*, *Journal of Economic Literature*, *American Economic Journal: Applied Economics*, *American Economic Journal: Macroeconomics*, *Journal of Labor Economics*, *Journal of Human Resources*, *ILR Review*, *Labour Economics*, *Journal of Development Economics*, *Science*, *Science Advances*, *Journal of Economic Growth*, *Journal of Economic History*, *Economic Development and Cultural Change*, *Journal of International Economics*, *World Development*, *Journal of Population Economics*, *Journal of Health Economics*, *World Bank Economic Review*, *Journal of Politics*, *Scandinavian Journal of Economics*, *Economic Inquiry*, *Public Choice*, *European Economic Review*, *The Lancet*, *International Migration Review*, *Population and Development Review*, *Journal of Globalization and Development*, *Regional Science and Urban Economics*, *Journal of Economic Surveys*, *European Economic History Review*, *Journal of Development Effectiveness*, *Review of World Economics*, *Journal of Iberian and Latin American History*, *Journal of International Money and Finance*, *Economic Notes*, National Science Foundation, World Bank Research Committee, Princeton University Press, Oxford University Press, MIT Press, Stanford University Press, Zed Books, *Journal of Economics and Growth of Developing Areas*, *Health Affairs*, *Human Resources for Health*, *Financial History Review*, *Social Science & Medicine*, *Georgetown University Public Policy Review*, numerous external academic tenure reviews.

Influence

<i>Research</i>	Academic citation statistics at: Google Scholar SSRN RePEc IDEAS ResearchGate Invited to IOM Migration Research Leaders Syndicate, 2017 Top 0.57% of academic economists on RePEc IDEAS citations (398 out of 70,287 economists), for publications in the last ten years: Jan. 2015–Jan. 2025 Replication data and code: https://dataverse.harvard.edu/dataverse/mclem “Six Vital Voices on the Economics of Migration”, by <i>NewsDeeply</i>
<i>Social media</i>	“20 most influential think tank experts on Twitter, 2017” by ESGlobal. <i>Foreign Policy</i> magazine “Who’s who of the foreign policy Twitterverse” 2012 and 2013.

Personal

Languages	English (native); Spanish (advanced) Portuguese, French, Turkish (intermediate)
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